Paediatric Neurology – A Vital Specialty

The brain and nervous system are the control centre of the human body, orchestrating every function from movement to thought processes. When something goes wrong with this system, it can have widespread consequences, affecting every aspect of a person's health. Paediatric neurology is a critical specialty that focuses on the diagnosis and treatment of neurological disorders in children, addressing issues that may be present at birth or develop later in childhood.

At **Dheemahi Clinic**, we specialize in comprehensive paediatric neurological care for children from birth to adolescence. Our team, led by **Dr. Yatheesha B L**, is dedicated to ensuring your child receives expert attention for a wide range of neurological conditions. Whether the problem is common, like migraines or epilepsy, or rare and complex, we provide individualized care tailored to your child's needs.

What is a Paediatric Neurologist?

A paediatric neurologist is a medical doctor who specializes in treating children with neurological disorders, which can affect the brain, spine, and nervous system. These doctors undergo extensive training, allowing them to manage developmental, behavioural, and neurological conditions that are specific to children. Their expertise covers a wide spectrum of issues, including epilepsy, developmental delays, learning disorders, neuromuscular disorders, and more. Paediatric neurologists play a critical role in a child's health journey, addressing not just medical needs but also the developmental and emotional aspects of neurological care.

Dr. Yatheesha B L – An Expert in Paediatric Neurology

Dr. Yatheesha B L is one of the leading paediatric neurologists in the region, known for his expertise in child brain development and neurological disorders. His extensive background and education enable him to provide exceptional care for children with neurological challenges.

- **Education & Training**:
  Dr. Yatheesha earned his **MBBS from M S Ramaiah Medical College** in Bangalore in 2003. Driven by a passion for child health, he completed a **Diploma in Child Health (DCH)** in 2006. After working as a paediatrician for several years, he pursued a **Post-Graduate Diploma in Developmental Neurology (PGD-DN)** from the **University of Trivandrum**, and later a **Fellowship in Paediatric Neurology** from **Amrita Institute of Medical Science and Research Centre, Kochi**. This comprehensive training has equipped him with the skills to handle a wide variety of neurological issues in children.

- **Passion for Child Development**:
  Dr. Yatheesha has always had a deep interest in developmental neurology and has made it his life's mission to help children with neurological conditions. With over two

decades of experience, he has treated numerous children with conditions ranging from developmental delays to epilepsy, offering personalized care tailored to each child's unique circumstances. His commitment to advancing paediatric neurological care is evident in the many milestones he has achieved throughout his career.

Understanding Neurological Disorders in Children

Neurological disorders in children can stem from a variety of causes, including genetics, infections, physical injuries, and even lifestyle or nutrition-related issues. Many neurological conditions in toddlers are congenital, meaning they were present at birth, while others develop over time due to factors such as trauma or illness. Recognizing the signs and symptoms early can lead to more effective treatment and better outcomes.

Common Reasons to See a Paediatric Neurologist

Your child's paediatrician may refer them to a paediatric neurologist if they show any of the following symptoms:

- **Frequent headaches or seizures**
- **Poor balance or coordination**
- **Memory loss or unexplained confusion**
- **Numbness, tingling, or lack of sensation**
- **Tremors, tics, or involuntary movements**
- **Developmental delays in speech, motor skills, or behaviour**
- **Walking difficulties or instability**
- **Seizures or loss of consciousness**
  If your child is experiencing any of these symptoms, a paediatric neurologist can provide a thorough evaluation to determine the underlying cause and recommend appropriate treatments.

Neurological Conditions We Treat

At **Dheemahi Clinic**, we treat a wide range of neurological conditions that affect children. Some of the most common disorders we manage include:

1. **Epilepsy**
   Epilepsy, or seizure disorder, is one of the most common neurological conditions in children. It involves sudden surges of electrical activity in the brain, leading to seizures. Treatment for epilepsy has improved greatly in recent years, with new medications and therapies available to help children manage their condition effectively.
2. **Headaches & Migraines**
   Children can suffer from various types of headaches, including migraines and tension headaches. These can be caused by stress, infection, or minor head injuries. It's important to monitor a child's headache symptoms and seek medical advice if they become frequent or severe.

3. **Developmental Disorders**
   Developmental disorders, such as **Autism Spectrum Disorder (ASD)**, **Cerebral Palsy**, and **Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder (ADHD)**, affect a child's emotional, cognitive, and physical growth. These conditions often require specialized care and ongoing management to help children achieve their full potential.
4. **Intellectual Disability**
   Intellectual disabilities involve below-average cognitive abilities that impact a child's ability to perform day-to-day tasks. Children with intellectual disabilities can still learn and thrive with the right support and intervention.
5. **Neurological Infections**
   Infections like **Meningitis** and **Encephalitis** can affect the brain and nervous system. Early detection and treatment are critical in preventing long-term complications.
6. **Movement Disorders**
   These conditions cause either excessive or insufficient movement in children. Disorders such as **Tics**, **Tremors**, and **Ataxia** (poor coordination) fall into this category and require specialized care.
7. **Neuromuscular Disorders**
   Neuromuscular disorders affect the peripheral nerves and muscles. Conditions like **Muscular Dystrophy** and **Spinal Muscular Atrophy** can lead to muscle weakness and developmental delays.
8. **Stroke in Children**
   Though rare, strokes can occur in children, leading to brain damage and loss of motor function. Rapid treatment is essential to reduce the risk of long-term disability.

Advanced Services and Care at Dheemahi Clinic

At Dheemahi Clinic, we provide state-of-the-art diagnostic and therapeutic services to ensure your child receives the highest standard of care.

Neurophysiology Lab

Our Neurophysiology Lab is equipped with advanced technology to diagnose conditions related to the brain and nervous system. We conduct comprehensive testing for conditions like epilepsy, movement disorders, and developmental delays. Our highly skilled technicians work closely with our paediatric neurologists to ensure accurate and timely results, which are crucial for determining the best treatment approach.

Neurological Rehabilitation

Rehabilitation is a key component of treatment for many neurological disorders. Our rehabilitation programs are tailored to each child's specific needs, focusing on improving function, reducing symptoms, and enhancing overall quality of life. Our team of specialists provides support for children recovering from brain injuries, strokes, or other neurological events, helping them regain mobility, speech, and cognitive abilities.

Insights into Paediatric Neurological Conditions

Population-based studies have shown that 15% of children aged 3 to 17 have some form of developmental disability. This includes conditions such as **Global Developmental Delay (GDD)**, which affects between 1% to 3% of children, and **Intellectual Disability (ID)**, which has a prevalence rate of 7.66%.

- **Cerebral Palsy** prevalence has remained stable at around 0.31% to 0.36% since the 1990s, while **Autism Spectrum Disorder (ASD)** now affects about 1.4% of children by the age of 8, according to recent data.
- Learning disabilities are also common, with incidence rates for reading disorders ranging from 5.3% to 11.8%, while math and writing disorders impact between 5.9% to 14.7% of children.

Early diagnosis and intervention are critical for managing these conditions effectively. At Dheemahi Clinic, we focus on providing early and accurate diagnoses, followed by individualized treatment plans designed to help children lead fulfilling lives.

Conclusion: A Future Full of Potential

At **Dheemahi Clinic**, we understand the challenges faced by families dealing with pediatric neurological conditions. Our goal is to provide compassionate, expert care that helps your child reach their full potential. Whether your child is dealing with a common condition like migraines or a more complex issue like epilepsy or developmental delays, we are here to guide you every step of the way.

Contact us today to schedule a consultation and learn more about how we can help your child thrive.